

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠X

Declarer: East

Board: 5

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: South

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 7 5 4 3

♥ Q 10 3

♦ A 4

♣ J 10 3

♠ A 10 2

♥ A J 7

♦ J 8 6 2

♣ K 6 5



♠ J 6

♥ 9 8 5 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A Q 9 8

♠ K Q 9

♥ K 6 4

♦ K Q 10 3

♣ 7 4 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

2NT

Pass

1♦

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

♥Q, it didn't do anything that declarer wouldn't have done on his own.

Declarer must play ♦s to get some winners, and when West takes the ♦A he will surely switch to the ♣J. Down goes declarer.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥9, the top of nothing.

Your ♣s are so good that all your instincts tell you to lead the ♣8, and perhaps set up 3 winners.

If you had one more small ♣s your instincts would be right, but with only a 4-card suit you should think a little longer. Three tricks won't set this contract, so you must depend on partner winning something. And if partner is going to win something perhaps he will lead a ♣ and you might make FOUR tricks in the suit.

So lead the ♥9. You lead a high card so partner won't be tempted to return the suit when he gets the lead. Note that although this lead finesses partner's

Board 3

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 10 8

♥ 7

♦ A 7 5 3 2

♣ 8 5 3 2

♠ 5

♥ K Q 9 6 3

♦ K 6

♣ K Q 10 9 6



♠ Q J 9 7 6 2

♥ A 8 5 4

♦ 4

♣ 7 4

♠ A 4 3

♥ J 10 2

♦ Q J 10 9 8

♣ A J

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

1 ♥

2 ♠

3 ♦

Pass

4 ♣

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

Pass

4 ♠

Dbl

4 ♠ X by East

will still be able to ruff one ♥ in dummy, but will be left with two losing ♥s and will be down 2. Without the two trump plays he could have ruffed all three of his ♥ losers and actually made the contract.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4 ♠ doubled

Lead the ♠ A.

East's 2 ♠ bid is a Weak-jump Overcall, based on a 6-card ♠ suit and a weak hand.

Either the ♦ Q or ♥ J would normally be good leads.

But on this deal West/East have clearly sacrificed against your almost certain ♥ game. Since they don't have enough high-card strength to make this contract declarer is hoping to get some ruffs.

The way to cut down the number of ruffs he can make is to lead a trump at every opportunity.

So take the ♠ A and then play another ♠. Declarer will still be able to ruff one ♥ in dummy, but will be left with two losing ♥s and will be down 2. Without the two trump plays he could have ruffed all three of his ♥ losers and actually made the contract.

Board 5

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 8 7 3
 ♥ Q 10 7 3
 ♦ 7 5
 ♣ 6 3 2

♠ 10 6 4

♥ 6 4 2

♦ K 9 4 2

♣ A K J



♠ Q 9 2

♥ K 8 5

♦ A 8 6

♣ 10 9 7 5

♠ A J 5

♥ A J 9

♦ Q J 10 3

♣ Q 8 4

West

North

East

South

Pass

3NT

1NT

All Pass

3NT by South
 cannot establish the ♠ winner.

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥3, fourth highest in an attacking suit.

Sometimes it comes down to just this kind of choice.
 Do you lead fourth down from ♠ K 8 7 3 or from
 ♥ Q 10 7 3.

The presence of the ♥10 bolsters the ♥ suit enough
 to give it the edge.

The suits could be arranged something like shown at
 left. With a ♠ lead the presence of the ♠10 in
 dummy allows declarer to make a second ♠ trick,
 which happens to be declarer's ninth trick.

But when you lead the ♥3 it does not promote a ♥
 winner for declarer, and left to his own devices, he